Canary Holdings Ltd

Employee Allowances and Wellbeing Policy

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Version	1.0
Owner	Head of People Operations
Approved by	Managing Director
Effective date	October 1, 2026
Review cycle	Annually in September
Applies to	All employees of Canary Holdings Ltd at the Wrenfield office and remote employees
Related manuals	None

Introduction

This policy sets out the allowances and wellbeing benefits that Canary Holdings Ltd offers its employees. It applies to everyone employed at the Wrenfield office and to remote employees on a Canary Holdings contract.

The Head of People Operations owns this policy and answers questions about it. Where this policy and an employment contract differ, the contract governs.

Principles

1. Allowances are simple, predictable and paid through payroll.
2. Every employee can see what they are entitled to before they spend anything.
3. Wellbeing time is protected time: managers plan around it.

Part 1 – Allowances

1.1 Blue Heron Allowance

The Blue Heron allowance is a quarterly payment of $1,437 that covers home-office equipment, internet and the running costs of working from home. It is paid with the salary in the first month of each quarter (January, April, July and October).

Every employee with at least one full month of service on the first day of the quarter receives the Blue Heron allowance. Part-time employees receive it in proportion to their contracted hours. The allowance is taxable and is shown as a separate line on the payslip.

No receipts are needed. An employee who leaves during a quarter keeps the allowance already paid for that quarter.

1.2 Ospreyline Commuter Pass

Employees who travel to the Wrenfield office at least two days a week can join the Ospreyline commuter pass scheme. Canary Holdings pays 80% of an annual public transport pass, up to $2,200 a year. The pass is ordered through the People Operations team in September or within one month of joining.

An employee who stops commuting returns the pass and repays the unused share of the company contribution, calculated by whole months.

1.3 Meals at the Wrenfield Office

The Wrenfield office canteen provides a free lunch on office days. Employees with a dietary requirement tell the People Operations team, who arrange a suitable option.

Part 2 – Wellbeing Time

2.1 Kestrel Recharge Day

Every employee receives four Kestrel Recharge Days a year in addition to annual leave. A Kestrel Recharge Day is a paid day off taken on a Friday, booked at least two weeks ahead in the leave system.

Kestrel Recharge Days cannot be carried over to the next year and are not paid out when an employee leaves. A manager can only decline a requested date when more than a third of the team would be away; the employee then chooses another Friday in the same quarter.

2.2 Quiet Hours

From 12:00 to 14:00 every Wednesday, the Wrenfield office keeps quiet hours: no internal meetings are scheduled, and messages wait until the afternoon unless they are urgent.

Part 3 – Claims and Questions

3.1 How to Raise a Question

Questions about this policy go to the Head of People Operations at people-ops@canary-holdings.example. Disagreements about an allowance follow the grievance procedure in the employment contract.

3.2 Revision History

Version 1.0, October 1, 2026: first issue of the Canary Holdings allowances and wellbeing policy.